



Illustration: Rudy-Jan Faber (rudyfaber.com)

...would society find this type of love “cute”?

few decades, they will be even more humanlike, expressing emotions and possessing a personality, social instincts and physical (albeit artificial) features like pheromones – all necessary elements needed to fall in love. “Many people will be falling in love with them, having sex with them, and even marrying them,” Levy writes.

On the human side, he contends that trends in mankind’s history are such that it seems like a natural progression.

When the virtual pet Tamagotchi or the AIBO robotic dog first made an appearance, they were ridiculed. But slowly, people grew to appreciate them and form a bond as closely-knit as with a real pet.

Levy also observes that as society progresses, our attitude towards sex and sexual orientation starts becoming more liberal.

Of course, all of this throws up a plethora of ethical questions, but as Levy points out, it’s not about looking at things as a whole but more about looking at things from the perspective of a human relationship. In an interview with the *Scientific American*, he says, “It’s not that people will fall in love with an algorithm, but that people will fall in love with a convincing simulation of a human being, and convincing simulations can have a remarkable effect on people.” 